

Chapter 5

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet for Chapter 5: Mastering Time and Stress for Independence

Instructions: Complete each section of this worksheet thoughtfully. Use the space provided to write your answers. Refer to Chapter 5 in “Soft Skills for Success After High School” if you need guidance. Be prepared to discuss your responses with a classmate or teacher.

Part 1: Time Management Tools – Plan Your Week

Objective: Practice using advanced time management tools like time blocking and digital planners to organize a busy schedule. **Task:** Imagine it’s the start of a week after high school. You’re balancing college classes (or a job), personal responsibilities, and social life. Below is a list of tasks for the week. Use time blocking to create a rough schedule for Monday and Tuesday in the table provided. Include at least one break or personal time slot per day.

- College classes or work: 4 hours each on Monday and Tuesday
- Study or project work: 2 hours total across the two days
- Chores (e.g., laundry, grocery shopping): 1 hour total
- Social time with friends or family: 1 hour total
- Personal relaxation or hobby: 1 hour total

Monday Schedule (Time Blocks):

Time	Task/Activity	Notes (e.g., reminders, location)
8:00 AM –		

Time

Task/Activity

Notes (e.g., reminders, location)

8:00 AM –

Tuesday Schedule (Time Blocks):

Time	Task/Activity	Notes (e.g., reminders, location)
8:00 AM –		

Time

Task/Activity

Notes (e.g., reminders, location)

8:00 AM –

Reflection Questions:

- Which time management tool (e.g., time blocking, Pomodoro Technique) did you find most helpful while planning, and why?
- What challenges did you face when fitting all tasks into your schedule? How could a digital planner or app help with this?

Part 2: Prioritization – Apply the Eisenhower Matrix

Objective: Use the Eisenhower Matrix to prioritize tasks and make decisions about where to focus your energy. **Task:** Below is a list of tasks you might face in a typical week after high school. Categorize each task into one of the four quadrants of the Eisenhower Matrix (Urgent and Important, Important but Not Urgent, Urgent but Not Important, Neither). Then, write a brief plan for how you'd handle the tasks in each quadrant.

- Preparing for a job interview tomorrow
- Planning a long-term career goal or college major
- Helping a friend with a last-minute favor
- Scrolling through social media for entertainment
- Studying for a test in two weeks

Eisenhower Matrix:

Quadrant	Task(s)	Plan (e.g., Do now, Schedule, Delegate, Eliminate)
Urgent and Important		
Important but Not Urgent		
Urgent but Not Important		
Neither Urgent nor Important		

Quadrant

Task(s)

Plan (e.g., Do now, Schedule, Delegate, Eliminate)

Urgent and Important

Important but Not Urgent

Urgent but Not Important

Neither Urgent nor Important

Reflection Question: 3. How did using the Eisenhower Matrix help you decide what to focus on first? Was there a task you found hard to categorize? Why?

Part 3: Stress Management – Build Your Personal Toolkit

Objective: Identify stress triggers and create a personalized set of stress management strategies to use in high-pressure situations. **Task:** Think about life after high school and list three situations that might cause you stress (e.g., first day at a new job, balancing work and study, moving out). For each situation, choose one stress management technique from Chapter 5 (mindfulness/breathing, planning, physical activity/self-care) and explain how you'd apply it. Then, add one fun self-care idea to try during stressful times.

Stressful Situations and Strategies:

Situation (Potential Stressor)	Technique Chosen	How I'd Apply It
• 1.		

• 2.		
• 3.		

Situation (Potential Stressor)

Technique Chosen

How I'd Apply It

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Fun Self-Care Idea: (e.g., watching a funny video, calling a friend)

Reflection Question: 4. Which stress management technique do you think will be most useful for you, and why? Have you tried any of these before? If so, how did it work?

Part 4: Putting It All Together – Mini Scenario

Objective: Apply time management, prioritization, and stress management skills to a realistic post-high school scenario. **Task:** Read the scenario below and answer the questions that follow.

Scenario: It's Wednesday, and you're a college student with a part-time job. You have a major assignment due on Friday, a work shift tomorrow evening (4 hours), and a friend just invited you to a movie tonight. You also need to study for a quiz next week and haven't had much time to relax. Halfway through planning your day, you feel stressed about fitting everything in.

- **Time Management:** How would you use time blocking or the Pomodoro Technique to organize your Wednesday and Thursday? Write a brief plan for key tasks.
- **Prioritization:** Using the 80/20 Rule or Eisenhower Matrix, which task(s) would you focus on most, and why? Would you say no to the movie invite? If so, how would you phrase it?
- **Stress Management:** What technique would you use to manage the stress of this busy schedule? Describe how you'd apply it.

Part 5: Self-Reflection

Objective: Reflect on how the skills from Chapter 5 can prepare you for independence after high school.

Questions: 5. Which skill (time management, prioritization, or stress management) do you think will be most important for your future, and why?

- What's one small action you can take this week to start practicing one of these skills (e.g., trying a time management app, saying no to a low-priority task, doing a breathing exercise)?